

C1382 • ONE DAY

Claude Cowork Masterclass

Eight practical automations for
Excel, research, reporting and
scheduled finance tasks



Leave with eight tasks you can reuse

UPDATE

latest finance data

RESEARCH

current AI news

CREATE

Excel and PowerPoint

EXTRACT

invoice details

EXPLAIN

budget variances

MONITOR

cash flow

DRAFT

management email

SCHEDULE

weekly briefing

Watch it · try it · check it · reuse it

1

**See a finance
scenario**

2

**Use a ready
prompt**

3

**Inspect the
output**

4

Save the skill

SIMPLE RULE

Use one dedicated folder per task



READ

mock-data and task brief

WORK

working copy only

SAVE

finished files in outputs

Five lines make a useful Cowork brief

OUTCOME

What should be finished?

INPUTS

Which files or sources?

OUTPUT

What filename and format?

CHECK

How do we know it is right?

STOP

What needs human approval?

Three topics · eight practical labs

TOPIC 1

Set up and refresh

Labs 1–2

TOPIC 2

Research and present

Labs 3–4

TOPIC 3

Monitor and deliver

Labs 5–8

Set Up and Refresh

Build a reusable workspace and keep Excel current



USE CASE 01 • SET UP ONCE

Create a Cowork Project

A reusable workspace for every finance task



From repetitive work to a finished outcome

BEFORE

Files and instructions live in different places



AFTER

A reusable workspace for every finance task

What Cowork receives

FILE

Project brief

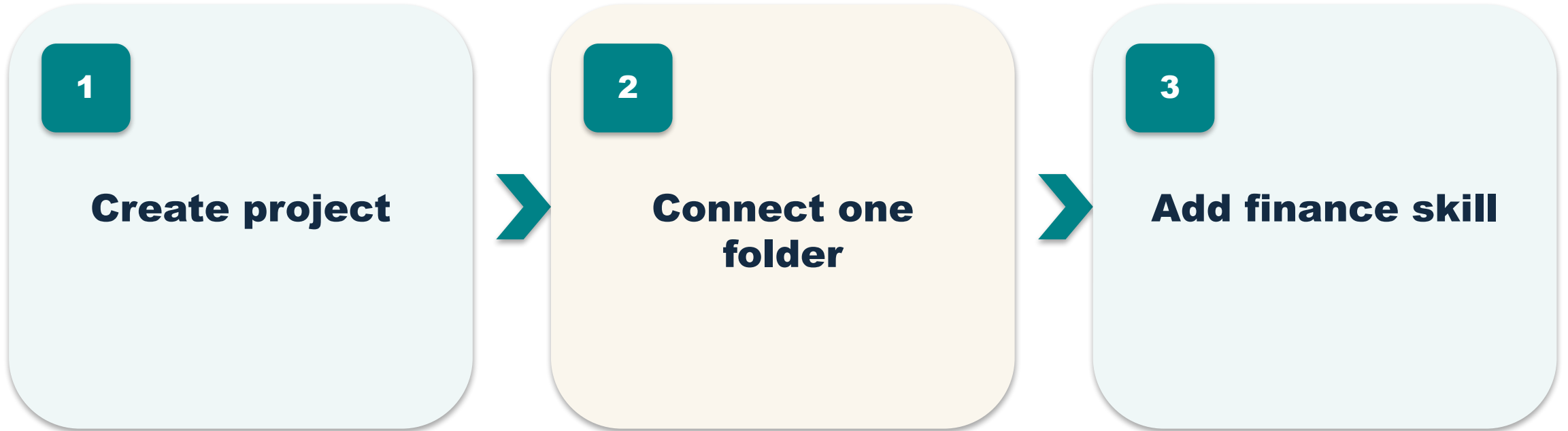
BRIEF

Close checklist

CHECK

Dedicated lab folder

What Cowork does



Build the request in five clear parts

OUTCOME

A reusable workspace for every finance task

INPUT

Project brief, Close checklist

ACTION

Give Cowork one project, one folder and clear rules

CHECK

File map lists every source; originals stay unchanged

STOP

Pause before sending, scheduling or publishing

The task needs three simple capabilities

FIND & READ

Project brief

Cowork Projects

BUILD

**A reusable
workspace for every
finance task**

Local folder access

REVIEW OR DELIVER

**File map lists every
source; originals
stay unchanged**

Project instructions

Preview the finished output



FINISHED

A reusable workspace for every finance task

File map lists every source; originals stay unchanged

One human check before you use it

CHECK

File map lists every source; originals stay unchanged

If this does not match, correct the output and run the check again.

When this automation helps

WHO

Finance analyst

WHEN

At the start of a recurring task

What good looks like

1

One clear task folder

2

Originals remain unchanged

3

Project rules persist

Try a useful variation

PERIOD

Quarter-end close

AUDIENCE

New team member

OUTPUT

Policy review

Finish line



YOU ARE DONE WHEN

File map lists every source; originals stay unchanged

Save the skill for the next reporting period.

Refresh an Excel Dashboard

Current KPIs and charts in one Excel file



From repetitive work to a finished outcome

BEFORE

The dashboard shows last month's figures



AFTER

Current KPIs and charts in one Excel file

What Cowork receives

FILE

**Three dated CSV
files**

BRIEF

Dashboard template

CHECK

Expected KPI check

What Cowork does



Build the request in five clear parts

OUTCOME

Current KPIs and charts in one Excel file

INPUT

Three dated CSV files, Dashboard template

ACTION

Find the newest dated file and refresh the workbook

CHECK

September: revenue S\$128k, expenses S\$89.5k, net S\$38.5k

STOP

Pause before sending, scheduling or publishing

The task needs three simple capabilities

FIND & READ

Three dated CSV files

Cowork files

BUILD

Current KPIs and charts in one Excel file

Spreadsheet skill

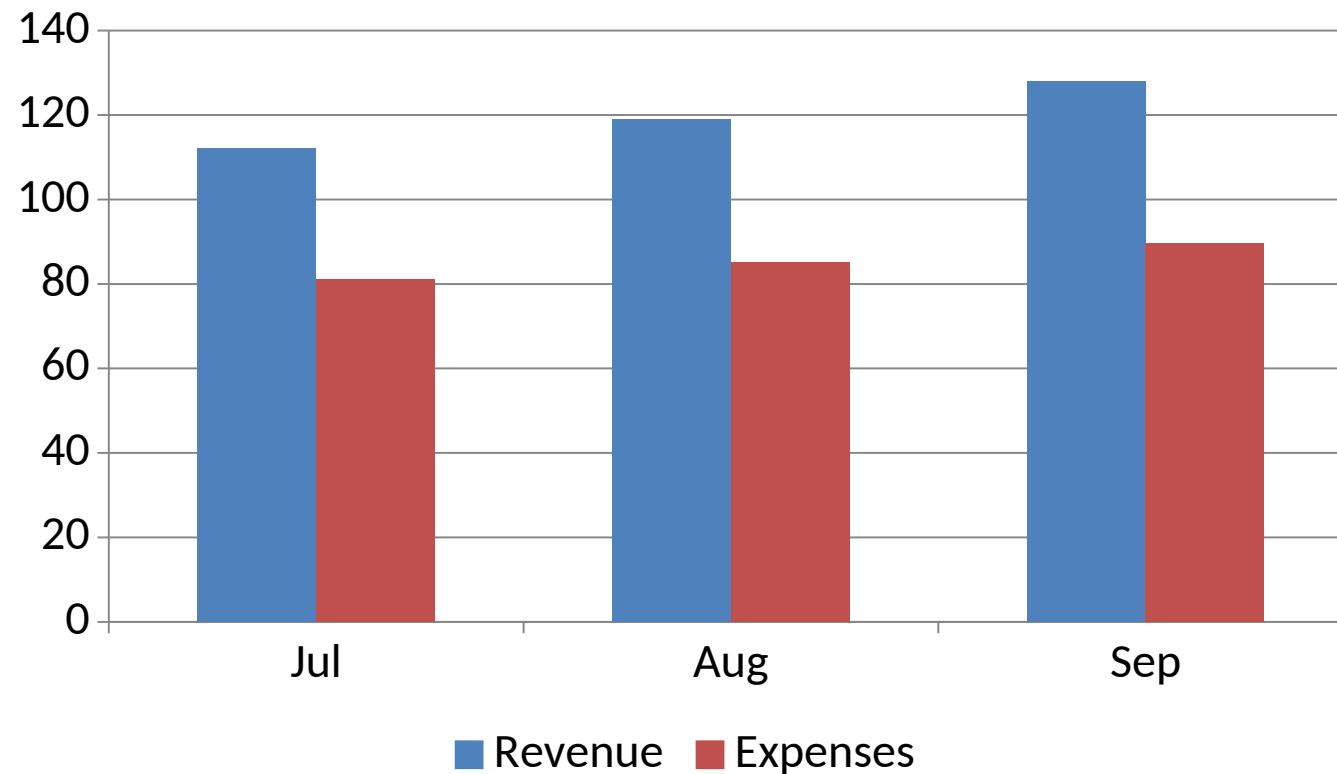
REVIEW OR DELIVER

**September: revenue
S\$128k, expenses
S\$89.5k, net S\$38.5k**

Microsoft Excel

Preview the finished output

Monthly finance view (S\$000)



FINISHED

Current KPIs and charts in one Excel file

September: revenue S\$128k, expenses S\$89.5k, net S\$38.5k

One human check before you use it

CHECK

September: revenue S\$128k, expenses S\$89.5k, net S\$38.5k

If this does not match, correct the output and run the check again.

When this automation helps

WHO

Reporting analyst

WHEN

When a new month file arrives

What good looks like

1

Newest dated source chosen

2

KPIs match control totals

3

Charts show the new period

Try a useful variation

PERIOD

Weekly cash data

AUDIENCE

Department view

OUTPUT

Different KPI target

Finish line



YOU ARE DONE WHEN

September: revenue S\$128k, expenses S\$89.5k, net S\$38.5k

Save the skill for the next reporting period.

Set Up and Refresh

USE CASE 01

A reusable workspace for every finance task

USE CASE 02

Current KPIs and charts in one Excel file

Research and Present

Turn live information and finance data into clear outputs



Research AI- in-Finance News

A structured Excel research
tracker



From repetitive work to a finished outcome

BEFORE

Interesting news is scattered across many websites



AFTER

A structured Excel research tracker

What Cowork receives

FILE

Research brief

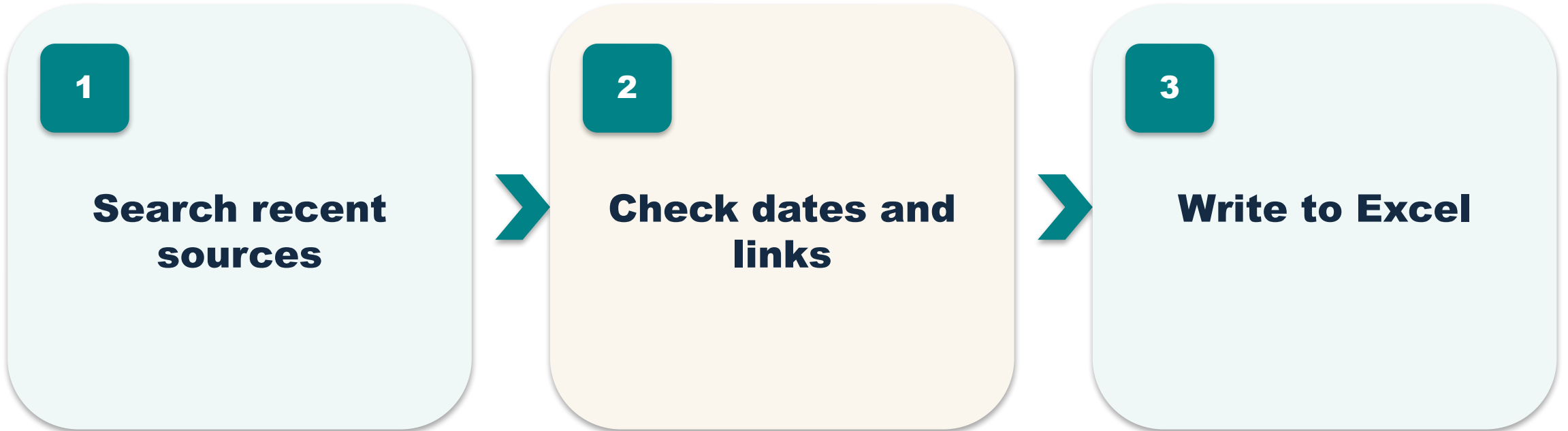
BRIEF

**Excel tracker
template**

CHECK

Live web sources

What Cowork does



Build the request in five clear parts

OUTCOME

A structured Excel research tracker

INPUT

Research brief, Excel tracker template

ACTION

Find six recent, credible developments and cite each source

CHECK

Six direct links open; every date and summary is sourced

STOP

Pause before sending, scheduling or publishing

The task needs three simple capabilities

FIND & READ

Research brief

Cowork web search

BUILD

**A structured Excel
research tracker**

Web fetch

REVIEW OR DELIVER

**Six direct links
open; every date and
summary is sourced**

Spreadsheet skill

Illustrative research tracker preview

DATE	SOURCE	DEVELOPMENT	LINK
LIVE CHECK	MAS	Responsible AI	mas.gov.sg
LIVE CHECK	BIS	Cross-border AI	bis.org
LIVE CHECK	IMF	AI readiness	imf.org
LIVE CHECK	ECB	AI in banking	ecb.europa.eu
LIVE CHECK	Bank of England	AI survey	bankofengland.co.uk
LIVE CHECK	OECD	AI policy	oecd.org

LIVE CHECK

Open each link
Confirm publish date
Keep only recent items
Summarise the source

One human check before you use it

CHECK

Six direct links open; every date and summary is sourced

If this does not match, correct the output and run the check again.

When this automation helps

WHO

Finance strategy team

WHEN

Before a market or risk briefing

What good looks like

1

Six recent developments

2

Direct sources open

3

Summary fits the brief

Try a useful variation

PERIOD

Regulation news

AUDIENCE

Competitor update

OUTPUT

Risk-only tracker

Finish line



YOU ARE DONE WHEN

Six direct links open; every date and summary is sourced

Save the skill for the next reporting period.

Turn Finance Data into Slides

Clear charts, messages and next
actions



From repetitive work to a finished outcome

BEFORE

Leaders receive a dense workbook



AFTER

Clear charts, messages and next actions

What Cowork receives

FILE

Quarterly workbook

BRIEF

Manager brief

CHECK

Brand guide

What Cowork does



Build the request in five clear parts

OUTCOME

Clear charts, messages and next actions

INPUT

Quarterly workbook, Manager brief

ACTION

Turn the numbers into a five-slide update

CHECK

Five slides; Q3 revenue S\$378k and net S\$108.5k match Excel

STOP

Pause before sending, scheduling or publishing

The task needs three simple capabilities

FIND & READ

Quarterly workbook

Cowork files

BUILD

**Clear charts,
messages and next
actions**

Spreadsheet skill

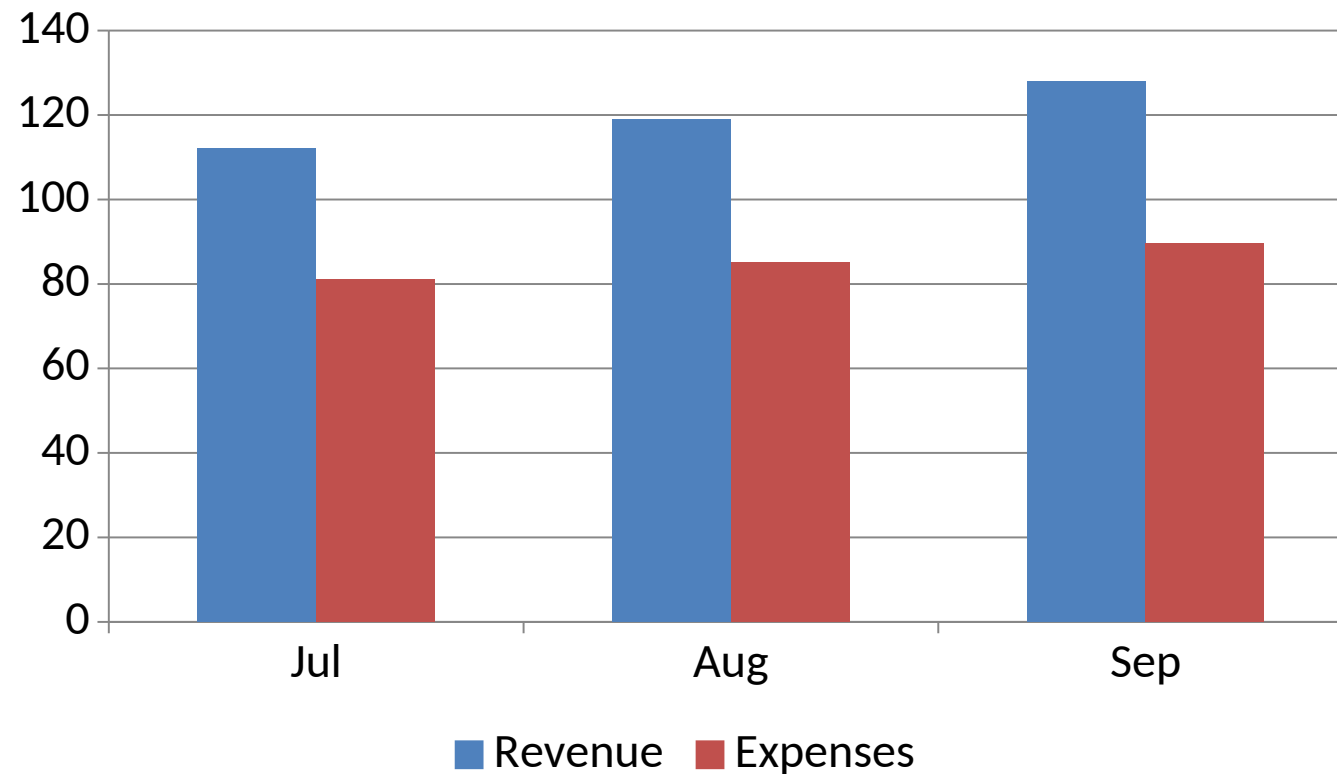
REVIEW OR DELIVER

**Five slides; Q3
revenue S\$378k and
net S\$108.5k match
Excel**

PowerPoint skill

Preview the finished output

Monthly finance view (S\$000)



FINISHED

Clear charts, messages and next actions

Five slides; Q3 revenue S\$378k and net S\$108.5k match Excel

One human check before you use it

CHECK

Five slides; Q3 revenue S\$378k and net S\$108.5k match Excel

If this does not match, correct the output and run the check again.

When this automation helps

WHO

Finance business partner

WHEN

Before a management meeting

What good looks like

1

Five-slide story

2

Figures match Excel

3

Actions are explicit

Try a useful variation

PERIOD

Board audience

AUDIENCE

Investor update

OUTPUT

One-page summary

Finish line



YOU ARE DONE WHEN

Five slides; Q3 revenue S\$378k and net S\$108.5k match Excel

Save the skill for the next reporting period.

Research and Present

USE CASE 03

A structured Excel research tracker

USE CASE 04

Clear charts, messages and next actions

TOPIC 03

Monitor and Deliver

Extract, explain, monitor and deliver routine finance work



Build an AP Tracker from Invoices

A tidy AP tracker ready for review



From repetitive work to a finished outcome

BEFORE

Invoice details are copied one file at a time



AFTER

A tidy AP tracker ready for review

What Cowork receives

FILE

**Five mock invoice
PDFs**

BRIEF

AP tracker template

CHECK

Review rules

What Cowork does



Build the request in five clear parts

OUTCOME

A tidy AP tracker ready for review

INPUT

Five mock invoice PDFs, AP tracker template

ACTION

Extract five invoices and flag anything uncertain

CHECK

Five rows; duplicate INV-204 and missing PO are visible

STOP

Pause before sending, scheduling or publishing

The task needs three simple capabilities

FIND & READ

**Five mock invoice
PDFs**

Document reading

BUILD

**A tidy AP tracker
ready for review**

PDF skill

REVIEW OR DELIVER

**Five rows; duplicate
INV-204 and missing
PO are visible**

Spreadsheet skill

Preview the finished output

INVOICE	SUPPLIER	TOTAL	STATUS
INV-201	Northstar	S\$1,250	READY
INV-202	Greenfield	S\$2,180	READY
INV-203	Metro	S\$860	READY
INV-204	Northstar	S\$1,250	DUPLICATE
INV-205	Bluewave	S\$3,400	MISSING PO

EXCEPTIONS

Duplicate retained for review

Missing PO remains unresolved

One human check before you use it

CHECK

Five rows; duplicate INV-204 and missing PO are visible

If this does not match, correct the output and run the check again.

When this automation helps

WHO

Accounts payable team

WHEN

When invoice batches arrive

What good looks like

1

All five invoices captured

2

Duplicate remains visible

3

Missing PO is flagged

Try a useful variation

PERIOD

Expense receipts

AUDIENCE

Purchase orders

OUTPUT

Vendor statements

Finish line



YOU ARE DONE WHEN

Five rows; duplicate INV-204 and missing PO are visible

Save the skill for the next reporting period.

Write Budget Variance Commentary

A reviewed workbook and one-page commentary



From repetitive work to a finished outcome

BEFORE

Managers see variances but not the story



AFTER

A reviewed workbook and one-page commentary

What Cowork receives

FILE

Budget vs actual

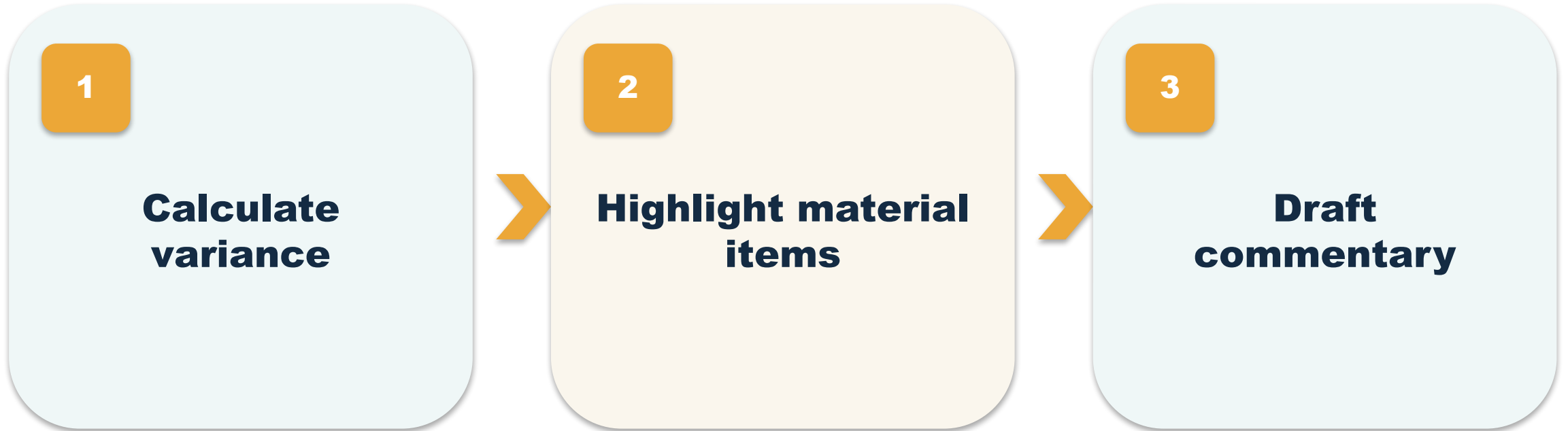
BRIEF

Department notes

CHECK

Materiality rule

What Cowork does



Build the request in five clear parts

OUTCOME

A reviewed workbook and one-page commentary

INPUT

Budget vs actual, Department notes

ACTION

Calculate material variances and explain them simply

CHECK

Each comment links to a line item or is marked as a question

STOP

Pause before sending, scheduling or publishing

The task needs three simple capabilities

FIND & READ

Budget vs actual

Cowork files

BUILD

**A reviewed
workbook and one-
page commentary**

Spreadsheet skill

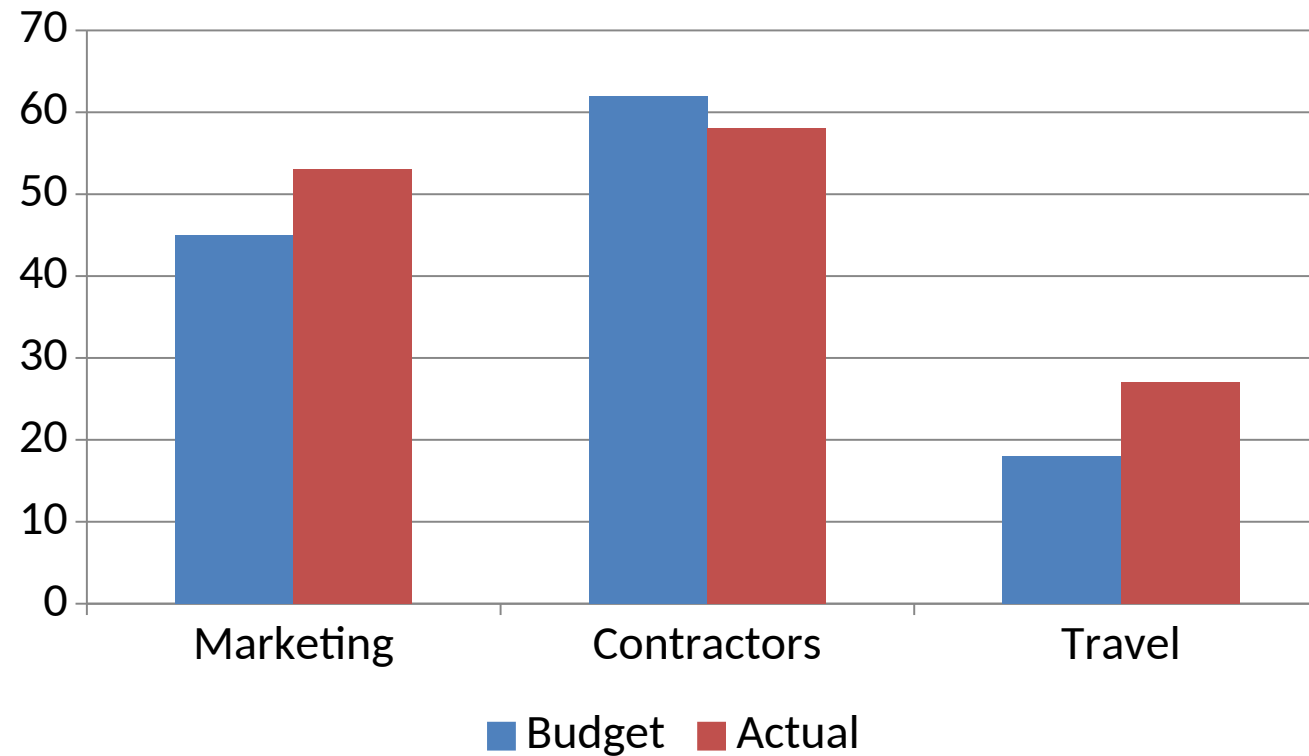
REVIEW OR DELIVER

**Each comment links
to a line item or is
marked as a
question**

Document skill

Preview the finished output

Budget vs actual (\$000)



COMMENTARY

Marketing +S\$8k: campaign timing.

Travel +S\$9k: client visits.

Contractors -S\$4k: delayed onboarding.

One human check before you use it

CHECK

Each comment links to a line item or is marked as a question

If this does not match, correct the output and run the check again.

When this automation helps

WHO

Cost-centre owner

WHEN

During the monthly review

What good looks like

1

Material items highlighted

2

Reason ties to evidence

3

Unknowns become questions

Try a useful variation

PERIOD

Headcount variance

AUDIENCE

Project spend

OUTPUT

Forecast changes

Finish line



YOU ARE DONE WHEN

Each comment links to a line item or is marked as a question

Save the skill for the next reporting period.

Build a Cash-Flow Watchlist

A cash watchlist and reviewed email draft



From repetitive work to a finished outcome

BEFORE

Receipts and payments sit in separate files



AFTER

A cash watchlist and reviewed email draft

What Cowork receives

FILE

Receivables

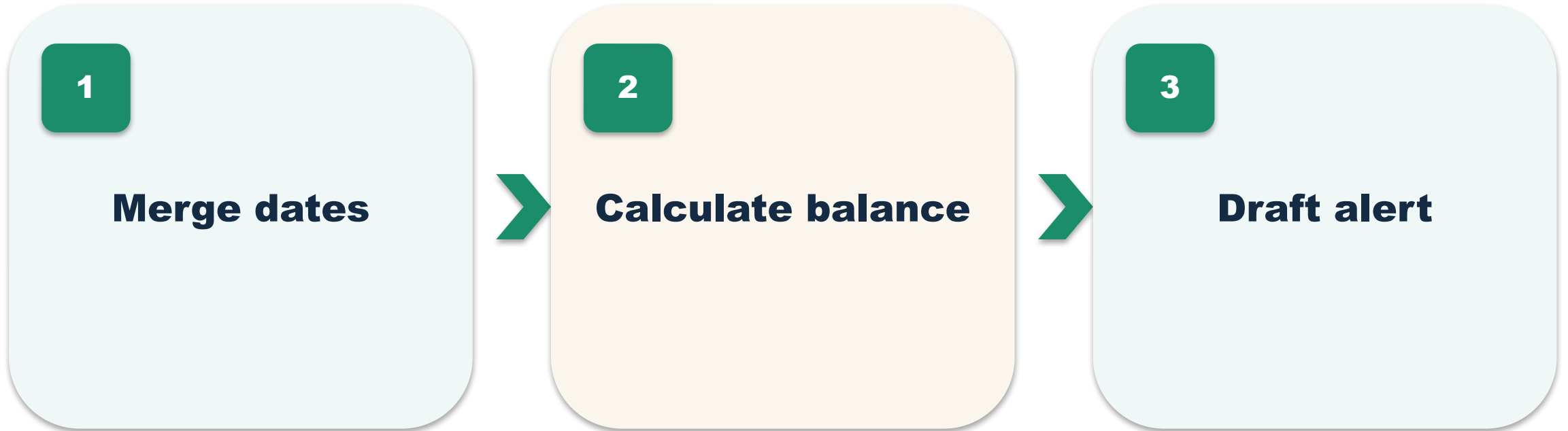
BRIEF

Payments

CHECK

Cash assumptions

What Cowork does



Build the request in five clear parts

OUTCOME

A cash watchlist and reviewed email draft

INPUT

Receivables, Payments

ACTION

Combine them into a 14-day running balance

CHECK

Low-balance day and top payments match the workbook

STOP

Pause before sending, scheduling or publishing

The task needs three simple capabilities

FIND & READ

Receivables

Cowork files

BUILD

A cash watchlist and reviewed email draft

Spreadsheet skill

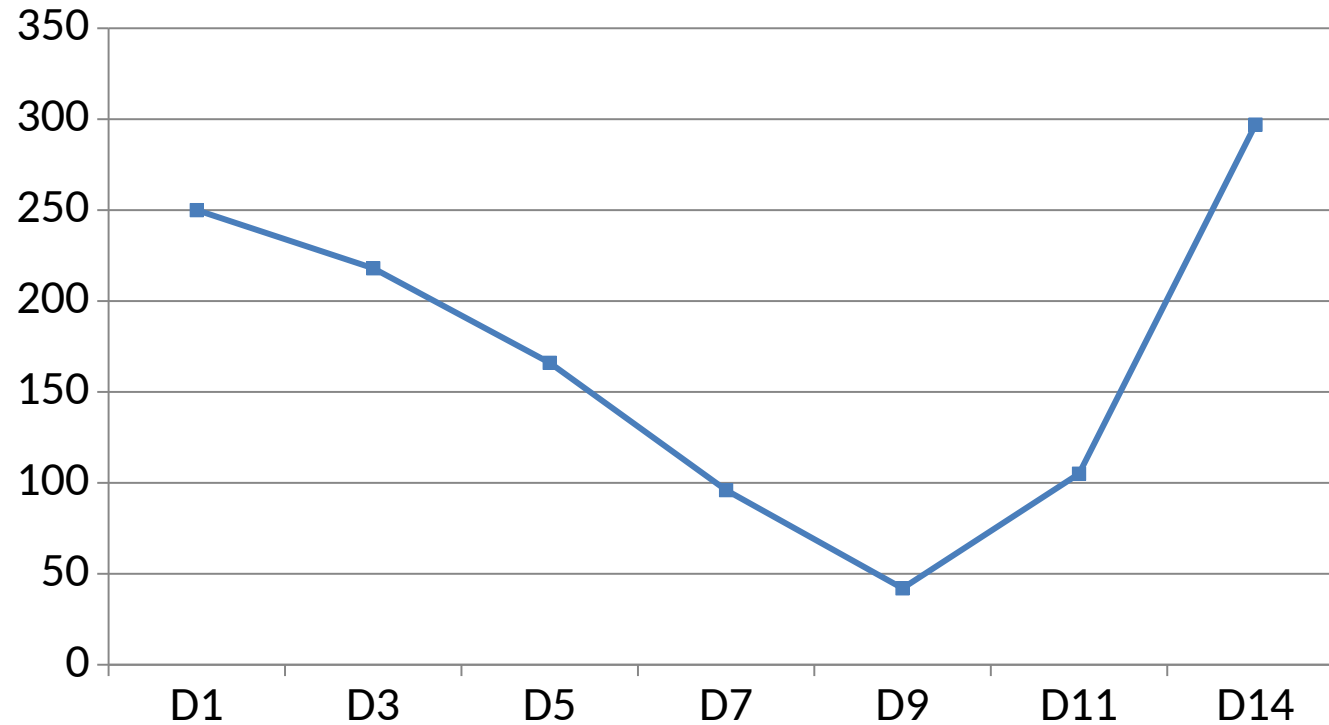
REVIEW OR DELIVER

Low-balance day and top payments match the workbook

Outlook draft

Preview the finished output

14-day running balance (S\$000)



WATCHLIST

Day 9: S\$42k low point

Top payment: S\$92k

Expected recovery: Day 11

Email remains a draft.

One human check before you use it

CHECK

Low-balance day and top payments match the workbook

If this does not match, correct the output and run the check again.

When this automation helps

WHO

Treasury analyst

WHEN

Before the daily cash call

What good looks like

1

14-day balance reconciles

2

Low point is visible

3

Email remains a draft

Try a useful variation

PERIOD

30-day horizon

AUDIENCE

Currency view

OUTPUT

Scenario stress test

Finish line



YOU ARE DONE WHEN

Low-balance day and top payments match the workbook

Save the skill for the next reporting period.

Schedule a Weekly Finance Briefing

A controlled weekly routine ready
for approval



From repetitive work to a finished outcome

BEFORE

The same briefing is rebuilt every Monday



AFTER

A controlled weekly routine ready for approval

What Cowork receives

FILE

Approved workbook

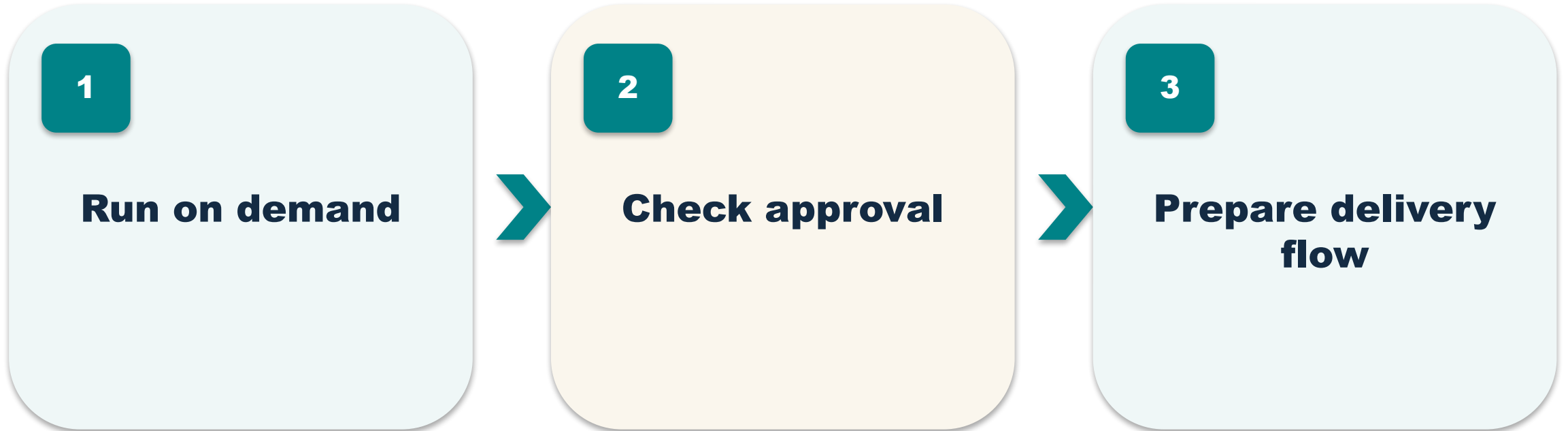
BRIEF

Release checklist

CHECK

Test recipient

What Cowork does



Build the request in five clear parts

OUTCOME

A controlled weekly routine ready for approval

INPUT

Approved workbook, Release checklist

ACTION

Rehearse a scheduled task using only an approved workbook

CHECK

Draft stays on demand; unapproved workbook is rejected

STOP

Pause before sending, scheduling or publishing

The task needs three simple capabilities

FIND & READ

Approved workbook

Scheduled tasks

BUILD

**A controlled weekly
routine ready for
approval**

OneDrive

REVIEW OR DELIVER

**Draft stays on
demand; unapproved
workbook is
rejected**

Outlook + Power Automate

Preview the finished output



On demand rehearsal first • approval gate • test recipient • schedule remains disabled

One human check before you use it

CHECK

Draft stays on demand; unapproved workbook is rejected

If this does not match, correct the output and run the check again.

When this automation helps

WHO

Finance operations lead

WHEN

Before the Monday briefing

What good looks like

1

Only approved file enters flow

2

Test recipient is used

3

Schedule remains disabled

Try a useful variation

PERIOD

Monthly pack

AUDIENCE

Different approver

OUTPUT

Teams notification

Finish line



YOU ARE DONE WHEN

Draft stays on demand; unapproved workbook is rejected

Save the skill for the next reporting period.

Monitor and Deliver

USE CASE 05

A tidy AP tracker ready for review

USE CASE 06

A reviewed workbook and one-page commentary

USE CASE 07

A cash watchlist and reviewed email draft

USE CASE 08

A controlled weekly routine ready for approval

Eight tasks, one repeatable pattern

1

Choose inputs

2

Ask clearly

3

Review output

4

Reuse the skill

Start with one task that already repeats



PICK

one folder and one outcome

RUN

on demand before scheduling

REVIEW

numbers, sources and recipient

Draft first - approve before action

FILES

Work from a copy

FACTS

Check numbers and links

ACTIONS

Review before send or
schedule

COURSE COMPLETE

Your Cowork automation toolkit is ready

Eight scenarios · eight reusable skills · one clear review habit

